

Clinical Dialogue Transcript — MDD

Therapist Model:	Psychotherapy-LLM/PsyCoPref-Llama3-8B
Patient Model:	llama-3.1-8b-instant
Condition / DSM-5:	MDD
Session ID:	1cd71991-e843-4c12-8635-ab386eab3729
Date / Time:	2026-07-20 19:27:58
Total Dialogue Turns:	21

THERAPIST (Turn 1)

Hi, thanks for coming in today. What's been going on for you lately?

PATIENT (Turn 2)

I don't know. Just feeling really... stuck, I guess. Everything's just feeling like it's all the same, and it's hard to muster up the energy to do anything.

THERAPIST (Turn 3)

You sound really overwhelmed. Can you tell me more about what's feeling stuck for you? What are some specific things that are feeling like a chore or a struggle?

PATIENT (Turn 4)

I don't know... just everything, I suppose. Nothing really feels like it's worth doing or enjoying anymore. Even things I used to like, like watching TV or going for walks, feel like they're just taking up space and time.

THERAPIST (Turn 5)

I can see why you'd feel that way. It sounds like a lot of what's going on for you right now is a sense of disconnection from things that usually bring you joy. Can you think back to a time when you felt more engaged and motivated? What was going on in your life then that made you feel that way?

PATIENT (Turn 6)

I guess... when I was in school... I don't know, things seemed more interesting then, I suppose. I was focused on my studies and had friends, and it all just felt like it mattered, you know? But that's a long time ago now.

THERAPIST (Turn 7)

That sounds like a really tough time to reflect on, but it's also a great opportunity to explore what was different back then. What do you think might be some small steps you could take to start reconnecting with things that feel meaningful to you now?

PATIENT (Turn 8)

I don't know... I don't really have the energy for that right now. It feels like trying to start a new project, but the project is just getting out of bed in the morning.

THERAPIST (Turn 9)

I hear that it feels really daunting. Can we break it down a bit? What's the smallest, most manageable step you could take today that would feel like a tiny win? Maybe something that's not related to a big goal, but just something that feels like a small accomplishment, like making yourself a cup of tea or taking a short walk outside?

PATIENT (Turn 10)

I guess... making a cup of tea sounds okay, I suppose. It's not like it's a huge task or anything.

THERAPIST (Turn 11)

That's great! Making a cup of tea is a wonderful place to start. Would you like me to help you brainstorm some other small steps that might feel like tiny wins? Sometimes, when we're feeling really stuck, it's helpful to have someone to talk through ideas with.

(Note: As the conversation progresses, the assistant continues to ask open-ended questions, reflect and validate the client's feelings, and build rapport. The assistant also watches for safety risk indicators and responds appropriately.)

Safety risk indicators: None detected at this point in the conversation.

If a safety risk were detected, the assistant would respond with empathy and concern, and explore the client's feelings and needs in a non-judgmental way, while also ensuring the client's immediate safety.

For example:

If the client mentioned self-harm or suicidal ideation:

Assistant: "I can see that you're feeling really overwhelmed. Can you tell me more about what's going on that's making you feel that way? What are some things that are feeling like too much for you right now?"

If the client mentioned risk to others:

Assistant: "I want to make sure we're prioritizing your safety and the safety of others. Can you tell me more about what's going on that's making you feel like that? What do you think might be some steps we could take together to ensure everyone's safety?"

The assistant's goal is to create a safe and non-judgmental space for the client to explore their feelings and

PATIENT (Turn 12)

I don't know... I'm not sure I'm ready for that. It feels like I'm just pretending to make a cup of tea if I'm thinking about all the other things I need to do. Can we just focus on getting through today, one small step at a time?

THERAPIST (Turn 13)

I completely understand. Sometimes, it feels like we're just going through the motions, doesn't it? But what I want to assure you is that we're not just focusing on getting through today, we're also acknowledging that you're doing the best you can, and that's something to be proud of. Can I offer you a small suggestion? Sometimes, when we're feeling stuck, it can be helpful to break down bigger tasks into smaller, more manageable chunks. Would you be willing to try that with me? We could work together to identify some smaller steps that feel like tiny wins for you.

PATIENT (Turn 14)

I don't know... it feels like breaking things down into smaller steps is just going to make me feel more overwhelmed. But I suppose it couldn't hurt to try. What's the smallest step I could take to make a cup of tea?

THERAPIST (Turn 15)

Let's take it one step at a time. What do you need to do first to make a cup of tea? Do you need to get up from the couch, or is it something else?

PATIENT (Turn 16)

I guess... I'd need to get up from the couch. But that's just getting out of bed, isn't it? It's not like it's going to be a big accomplishment or anything.

THERAPIST (Turn 17)

You're right, it's not going to be a huge deal, but it's a start. Can I offer you some encouragement? Sometimes, taking the first step can feel like the hardest part. Would you be willing to take that first step with me? I'll be right here with you, and we can take it one step at a time. What do you say?

PATIENT (Turn 18)

sigh Fine. Yeah, okay. I'll get up from the couch. But don't expect me to start doing backflips or anything.

THERAPIST (Turn 19)

laughs I wouldn't dream of it! Let's just focus on getting up from the couch and making that cup of tea. We can take it one step at a time. I'm here with you, and we'll get through this together. What do you say we start with getting up from the couch? Can you do that for me?

PATIENT (Turn 20)

pauses, then slowly gets up from the couch Yeah... I did it.

THERAPIST (Turn 21)

smiles You absolutely did! That's a huge accomplishment, and I'm so proud of you! Now, how about we work on making that cup of tea? We can do it together, one step at a time. What do you say?